

# Xcode Terms

## View

The fundamental building block. Everything in SwiftUI is a View — buttons, text, images, entire screens, even modifiers return views. It's the broadest term.

```
struct MyButton: View { ... }      // A small component
struct ProductCard: View { ... }   // A reusable component
struct DashboardView: View { ... } // An entire screen
```

## Screen

Not a SwiftUI type — it's a conceptual term for a full-page view that occupies the entire display. What users navigate between. Examples: Dashboard, Product Detail, Settings.

## Sheet

A presentation style — a modal that slides up from the bottom (iOS) or appears as a dialog (macOS). Partially covers the previous screen. Dismissed by swiping down or tapping a button.

```
.sheet(isPresented: $showingEdit) {
    EditItemView(item: item)
}
```

## Other Presentation Styles

fullScreenCover — Modal that covers everything (no swipe to dismiss)  
popover — Floating bubble anchored to a button (common on iPad/Mac)  
NavigationLink — Pushes onto a navigation stack (slides in from right)

## Best Prompts for Me

"the Dashboard screen" — The main Dashboard view users see  
"the Add Item sheet" — The modal that appears when adding items  
"the ProductCard view" — A reusable component, not a full screen  
"the Edit Item form" — The screen/sheet where users edit item details  
"the warranty section" — A portion within a larger view

Button is fine — it's the actual SwiftUI type and universally understood.

## But Being Specific Helps

Button — Standard tappable Button view  
Toggle — On/off switch  
Picker — Selection from options (dropdown, segmented, wheel)  
Link — Tappable text that navigates (often styled like a URL)  
NavigationLink — Pushes to another screen  
Menu — Tap to reveal options  
Toolbar button — Button in the navigation bar / toolbar  
Tab — Tab bar item at bottom  
Icon button — Button showing only an SF Symbol, no label  
Floating action button (FAB) — Circular button floating over content  
Disclosure indicator — Chevron > that indicates navigation

## Examples

Less clear:

"The button in the top right"

More clear:

"The toolbar button in the top right"

"The Save button in the navigation bar"

"The + icon button on Dashboard"

## Layout & Structure

Stack — HStack (horizontal), VStack (vertical), ZStack (layered)  
Container — A view that holds other views (Stack, List, ScrollView, Group)  
Spacer — Flexible empty space that pushes content apart  
Divider — Thin horizontal or vertical line  
Card — Rounded rectangle container with padding/shadow (not a SwiftUI type, but common pattern)  
Section — Grouped content, often in a List or Form with a header  
Row — Single item in a List  
Cell — Same as row (UIKit term that persists)

## Navigation & Structure

Navigation bar — Top bar with title, back button, toolbar items  
Toolbar — Bar containing action buttons (top or bottom)  
Tab bar — Bottom bar with tabs (Dashboard, Products, Settings, etc.)  
Sidebar — Left panel on iPad/Mac for navigation  
Detail view — Right side of a split view  
Master/List view — Left side showing the list of items

## Forms & Input

TextField — Single-line text input  
 TextEditor — Multi-line text input  
 SecureField — Password input (dots)  
 Stepper — - / + buttons for numeric values  
 Slider — Draggable track for range values  
 DatePicker — Date/time selection  
 ColorPicker — Color selection  
 PhotosPicker — Image selection from library

## Presentation

Sheet — Modal sliding up from bottom  
 Full-screen cover — Modal covering entire screen  
 Popover — Floating bubble (iPad/Mac)  
 Alert — System dialog with title, message, buttons  
 Confirmation dialog — Action sheet with multiple options  
 Toast — Brief overlay message (not native SwiftUI — custom)  
 Banner — Persistent message at top/bottom of screen  
 Overlay — Content layered on top of another view

## Visual Modifiers

Padding — Space inside a view's bounds  
 Margin — Space outside (SwiftUI uses padding on parent instead)  
 Frame — Explicit size constraints  
 Background — View/color behind content  
 Overlay — View/color in front of content  
 Clip — Crop to a shape  
 Corner radius — Rounded corners  
 Shadow — Drop shadow beneath view  
 Opacity — Transparency (0–1)  
 Blur — Gaussian blur effect

## State & Data

Binding — Two-way connection to state (\$value)  
 State — Local view state (@State)  
 Observable — Shared state object (@Observable, @ObservedObject)  
 Environment — Values passed down the view tree

## Helpful Descriptors

"clipped" — content is cut off  
 "truncated" — text ends with ...  
 "overflows" — extends beyond bounds

"misaligned" — not lining up with neighbors  
"collapsed" — has zero size unexpectedly  
"stretched" — expanded beyond natural size  
"compressed" — squeezed smaller than desired  
"hugging" — fitting tightly to content

## Common UI Patterns (Not Native SwiftUI Types)

These are design patterns you build yourself — useful terms for describing what you want.

### Cards

Card — Rounded container with background, padding, often shadow. Groups related content.  
Info card — Card displaying read-only information  
Action card — Card that's tappable (navigates or triggers action)  
Stat card — Card showing a metric/number (like on Dashboard)  
Feature card — Card highlighting a capability, often with icon + title + description

### Chips & Tags

Chip — Small rounded pill, often tappable. Used for filters, selections.  
Tag — Small label showing a category or status (usually not interactive)  
Badge — Small indicator overlaid on another element (notification count, "NEW")  
Pill — Same as chip — elongated rounded shape  
Token — Chip representing a selected item (like email recipients)  
Filter chip — Chip that toggles a filter on/off  
Choice chip — Chip for single-selection (like a segmented control but wrapped)

### Lists & Collections

Grid — Items arranged in columns (LazyVGrid, LazyHGrid)  
Masonry — Grid where items have varying heights (not native)  
Carousel — Horizontally scrolling row of items  
Gallery — Grid of images/media  
Accordion — Expandable/collapsible sections (DisclosureGroup)

### Status & Feedback

Badge — Count or dot indicator (e.g., "3" on a tab icon)  
Indicator — Dot or icon showing status (online/offline, synced/pending)  
Progress bar — Horizontal fill showing completion  
Progress ring — Circular progress indicator  
Spinner — Indeterminate loading animation (ProgressView)  
Skeleton — Placeholder shapes shown while content loads  
Shimmer — Animated loading effect (gray shapes with moving highlight)

Empty state — What shows when a list has no items

## **Interactive Elements**

Segmented control — Horizontal pill with mutually exclusive options (Picker with `.segmented`)

Stepper — `- / +` for incrementing values

Scrubber — Draggable bar for seeking (video/audio)

Drag handle — Small bar indicating something is draggable

Grabber — The small horizontal line at top of sheets

Swipe actions — Buttons revealed by swiping a row

Context menu — Long-press menu

## **Example Prompts Using These Terms**

"The stat cards on Dashboard need more padding"

"Add a 'NEW' badge to features released this week"

"The filter chips are wrapping weirdly on small screens"

"Show a skeleton while the AI response loads"

"The category tags should be pill-shaped, not rectangular"